

as much as possible and taking some of that mental load off. The digital age has made it much easier to spend beyond your means and access unaffordable credit, but it's also made it much easier to manage your finances in a positive way too. You can set up new accounts and standing orders in seconds, on the bus, if you want to. Having access to all of your accounts – even your pension in some cases – on a device that you carry with you everywhere can help you to feel in control as you navigate daily life.

If your finances are currently complex or over-committed, or entwined with someone else's, streamlining them might be a gradual process. But at this point, it's a great idea to get all of that information out in front of you, leaving no stone unturned. All of your bills, accounts, debts and assets should be completely visible to you, because it's impossible to feel happy and relaxed about money if you're not actually sure what's going where, what your interest rates are and whether your arrangements are working for you.

For some people, a simple setup would look like having one account for bills, one for disposable income and incidental expenses, one for savings and one for paying off debt, whereas other people prefer to have their money all in one place. If you share finances with a partner, you might each have a personal account plus a joint account for bills, or you might pool absolutely everything together – it's a very personal choice. It's now time, though, to decide what about your financial arrangements is or isn't working for you. If you have multiple